Rong Zhang

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Personal Website: https://rongzhang123.github.io/

Education

Texas A&M University *2021 - Expected 2027*

Ph.D. Candidate in Agricultural Economics

Texas A&M University *2019 - 2021*

M.S. in Economics

Major: Financial Econometrics, GPA: 4.0/4.0

University of International Business and Economics, China *2015 - 2019*

B.A. in Economics

Major: International Economics and Trade

Research Area

Research Fields: Empirical Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics

Research Interests: Consumer Behavior, Pricing and Product Differentiation, Food Retail, Market Structure, Household Behavior and Inequality

Publication

The Pink Tax: Price Discrimination, Product Differentiation, and Gender-Based Pricing in Consumer Packaged Goods, with Yvette Zhang

Accepted, Southern Economic Journal

Working Papers

Educational Assortative Matching and Income Inequality in China

with Song Zhou and Yvette Zhang, Under Review

Economies of Scale, Product Composition, and Vertical Pricing in Food Retail

with Mengjie Li and Yvette Zhang

Research Report

Techno-Economic Analysis and Life Cycle Assessment of an Energy-Efficient Lignocellulosic Pulping Platform (in preparation)

USDA-NIFA funded research project, collaborated with Michigan State University

Work In Progress

When Lipstick Effect Meets Engel's Law: How Do Households Reallocate Spending across Economic Cycles?

with Lingxiao Wang, Wenying Li and Yvette Zhang

Powering AI: Data Centers and Electricity Market Outcomes

Conferences and Presentation

AEA Annual Meeting (ASSA)
Scheduled Paper Presentation, Jan 2027

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting
Scheduled Paper Presentation, Nov 2026

American Agricultural Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Conference
Paper Presentation, July 2026; Poster Presentation, July 2025

Chinese Economists Society (CES) North America Annual Conference
Paper Presentation, March 2025

Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA) Annual Meeting
Paper Presentation, February 2026

Symposium for Agricultural & Applied Economics Research
Paper Presentation, April 2025 & March 2026

Food Health & Applied Group Seminar, TAMU
Paper Presentation, December 2024 & February 2025

Econometrics Study Group, TAMU
Paper Presentation, August 2025

Teaching Experience

Research Tutor
INTA Capstone Research Course, Master of International Affairs Students

Teaching Assistant
AGEC 105 Introduction to Agricultural Economics
AGEC 625 Environment of Agribusiness (graduate level)
AGEC 350 Environmental and Natural Resource Economics
AGEC 440 Agribusiness Strategic Analysis
AGEC 325 Principles of Farm and Ranch Management
AGEC 431 Cases in Agribusiness Finance
AGEC 340 Agribusiness Management

Research and Work Experience

Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU *July 2025- December 2025*
Research Assistant for Dr. Yvette Zhang

Department of Economics, TAMU *April 2021-April 2023*
Research Assistant for Dr. Li Gan

Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU *January 2022-August 2022*
Research Assistant for Dr. Jean-Claude Bizimana

The Bush School of Government & Public Service, TAMU *December 2020-June 2022*
Research Assistant for Dr. Ren Mu

CoronaNet Research Group *June 2020 - August 2020*

Volunteer Research Assistant

China Development Research Foundation *May 2019 – September 2019*

Economics Research Intern

Grants and Awards

Research Assistantship, USDA-NIFA Grant, Summer & Fall 2025 & Summer 2026

Graduate Assistantship, Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU, Fall 2022 - Spring 2025

Graduate Scholarship, Department of Economics, TAMU, Fall 2019 – Spring 2021

Travel Grant, Graduate Students' Association (GSA), TAMU, Spring & Summer 2025, Summer 2026

Service

Referee, Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy, 2026

Technical Support, SAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Treasurer, Graduate Student Organization, TAMU, 2024-2025

Organizer, Food Health and Applied Group Meetings, AgEcon Department, TAMU, 2024

Skills

Programming: R, Python, Stata, GAMS

Methods: Discrete Choice Models, BLP Demand Estimation, Demand Systems, IV/GMM, Panel Data, Counterfactual Simulation

Other: LaTeX, openLCA

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)